

★ SoundChain — FAQ

Straight answers about the SoundChain desktop apps · v0.1 beta

The North Star node

Q · Is it really serverless?

Yes. North Star has no backend. Devices discover each other on your local network and exchange posts directly. There's no SoundChain server logging or storing anything — there's nothing to log it to.

Q · Who can see my posts?

Only the devices running the app on the **same local network** as you. It's a private mesh among the machines that are physically near each other.

Q · Why does it need the same Wi-Fi?

This beta discovers peers over your local network (the fastest, most private path). A future version adds secure internet-wide peering so distant friends can join too — same app, wider reach.

Q · Does it use my data or need an account?

No account, no sign-up, no tracking. Your posts live in a small file on *your* device and are shared only with the peers you're on a network with.

Q · Where is my data stored?

Locally, in the app's data folder on each device. Delete the app's data and it's gone — there's no copy in a cloud.

Installing & safety

Q · Why does my computer say "unidentified developer" / SmartScreen warns me?

Because it's a directly-downloaded beta that isn't code-signed/notarized yet. On macOS: **right-click → Open**. On Windows: **More info → Run anyway**. Signing certificates remove the warning in a later build — it's a formality, not a danger.

Q · Will it auto-update?

The app is wired for self-update; beta builds you install by hand. Once releases go live, updates arrive automatically.

The apps & the mission

Q · What's the difference between North Star and the SoundChain/Lucy/Arena/Mint apps?

North Star is the **sovereign, no-server** peer-to-peer app — the future. The SoundChain/Lucy/Arena/Mint apps are desktop windows for today's live platform. Over time, those move onto the same serverless foundation North Star proves.

Q · Is it free?

Free for long-time **L1 + L2** members. For everyone else, the full bundle is a one-time **\$10–\$20** — you own the file.

Q · Why sell a downloadable app at all?

Because a file you own can't be taken away, taxed by an app store, or switched off remotely. Selling a binary is selling a file — the same right that lets anyone sell a PDF.

Troubleshooting

Q · It says "solo — no peers found yet."

Make sure the other devices are (1) running the app and (2) on the **same Wi-Fi/network**. Some networks isolate devices ("client isolation" / "guest mode") — turn that off, or use a normal home network.

Q · The app won't open on macOS.

Right-click the app → **Open** → **Open**. If it's an Apple-Silicon vs Intel mismatch, grab the build that matches your chip (or the universal build).

Q · A post I made didn't show on the other laptop.

Give it a moment — the app re-syncs every few seconds and self-heals dropped messages. Confirm the peers pill shows the other device.

SoundChain · Operation North Star · free, open, peer-to-peer. See the **Manual** for step-by-step setup.